

ALERT ID	SOURCE SYSTEM	ALERT TIME	ANALYST
CLD-0109	Network Security Monitoring / Firewall Analytics	2026-09-01, beginning around 07:40 UTC	Eshak Basta

ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT):

- The rule “Periodic outbound connections to uncategorised destination” fired after three internal hosts, LDN-WS-104 (aria.reid), MAN-LT-033 (finn.gale), and AUS-WS-208 (dean.page) began making outbound HTTPS connections to 198.18.207.66 approximately every 60 seconds. The hosts were located in London, Manchester, and Austin. The destination was uncategorized by the firewall threat feed and associated with a recently registered domain.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS):

- Malicious: The three endpoints may be compromised and communicating with command-and-control infrastructure through periodic HTTPS beaconing.
- Benign: A legitimate application, agent, or newly deployed service may be generating scheduled outbound connections from all three systems.

EVIDENCE CHECKED:

- Reviewed the network alert and confirmed that three separate endpoints in three different offices were communicating with the same external destination at approximately 60-second intervals.
- Confirmed the destination IP was 198.18.207.66 and that the associated domain was recently registered and uncategorized by the firewall threat feed.
- Used KQL in Azure Data Explorer to establish sign-in baselines for Aria Reid, Finn Gale, and Dean Page.
- Aria Reid’s normal successful sign-ins were primarily from 203.0.113.13 in London. Several failed sign-in attempts from Lagos were identified, but none resulted in successful authentication.

- Finn Gale's normal successful sign-ins were from 198.51.100.24 in Manchester with no abnormal successful foreign authentications identified.
- Dean Page's normal successful sign-ins were from 192.0.2.31 in Austin with no abnormal successful foreign authentications identified.
- Reviewed CloudoraAudit_CL for the three users and found only routine administrative activity with no clear evidence of malicious account modifications.
- Based on the identity evidence, I did not identify indicators showing that cloud-account compromise was responsible for the network activity. The evidence instead points more strongly toward endpoint-side compromise or a malicious process executing on the affected systems.

VERDICT:

True positive	False positive	Duplicate	Escalate	Insufficient data
---------------	----------------	-----------	----------	-------------------

SEVERITY:

- Sev 2 — Confirmed malicious activity with high impact requiring immediate investigation and coordinated response
- The incident was assigned Sev 2 because the behavior affected three endpoints across separate geographic locations and showed a highly consistent automated beaconing pattern. The evidence strongly supports malicious endpoint activity, although the exact initial access vector has not yet been identified.

ACTION:

- Escalate to the Incident Response team and vCISO for coordinated containment and forensic investigation.
- Isolate LDN-WS-104, MAN-LT-033, and AUS-WS-208 through endpoint management.
- Block outbound communication to 198.18.207.66.
- Collect EDR telemetry and process execution history from all three endpoints.
- Review scheduled tasks, startup entries, recently installed software, browser downloads, DNS activity, and proxy logs.
- Compare the affected hosts for a common executable, application, software deployment, or other shared initial-access vector.

- Preserve forensic evidence before remediation or reimaging.

JUSTIFICATION:

- Three endpoints across separate offices established repeated HTTPS connections to the same newly registered, uncategorized destination at approximately 60-second intervals, while KQL analysis showed no corresponding abnormal successful sign-ins or suspicious account changes, indicating likely endpoint compromise rather than cloud-account takeover.

MITRE ATT&CK:**High confidence**

- **T1071.001 – Application Layer Protocol: Web Protocols**
- Why: The alert explicitly says the hosts are making **outbound HTTPS connections** every 60 seconds.

Possible

- **T1105 – Ingress Tool Transfer**
- Why: If malware was downloaded from the external host, this could fit.
- Problem: i have no evidence of file transfer, download activity, or tool delivery.